

Chapter 142-4

The two walked to the entrance of a milk tea shop. There happened to be a buy-two-get-a-discount promotion, so Xu Qingzhu went to buy two cups of milk tea.

When paying, she still didn't let Liang Shi do it.

After buying the milk tea, the two went to wait in the car. Both tacitly sat in the back seat.

Xu Qingzhu held her milk tea and nestled into Liang Shi's arms. "When are you joining the production crew?"

"Not sure yet." Liang Shi said: "Probably another week?"

"Alright."

Liang Shi's hand happened to be resting on her shoulder. She lifted it slightly and let it fall on her face, giving it a gentle pinch. "What's wrong? Already don't want to see me anymore?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu said: "It's just... I have to go on a business trip."

"When?" Liang Shi asked.

"If you're going to film in a week, then I'll..." Xu Qingzhu gave a soft cough. "Also go in a week."

Liang Shi was surprised: "Huh?"

Xu Qingzhu burrowed into her embrace, her head just happening to brush against her softness. "I don't want to leave."

Her voice was very soft, making Liang Shi's heart itch.

Liang Shi pinched her face again, but this time she couldn't bear to let go. Her fingernails caressed the side of her face. "Xu Qingzhu, why are you so..."

"What?" Xu Qingzhu said: "Do you want me to go on a business trip?"

Liang Shi: "...Not really."

"It's just that you being like this..." Liang Shi paused mid-sentence. Xu Qingzhu had already moved very close to her. The unopened milk tea was casually set aside, rolling on the car seat.

Then it rolled off the seat with a gurgling sound and fell to the floor.

Xu Qingzhu's hand landed on Liang Shi's shoulder as she slightly tilted her head up to look at Liang Shi.

Her hand slowly moved, coming to rest on Liang Shi's neck.

The cool touch of her hand made Liang Shi shiver. Before long, Xu Qingzhu's hand settled behind her ear.

Her glands grew slightly warm.

Liang Shi licked her lips, her throat making a sound—very low.

But in such a quiet environment, it was clearly audible.

Liang Shi's lips looked as if they were coated with lip gloss. Xu Qingzhu stared at her intently.

"Teacher Liang." Xu Qingzhu moved closer to her, the warm breath of her words spilling entirely onto her skin. "You didn't finish what you were saying. What's wrong with me being like this?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Having reached this point, even someone as slow as Liang Shi had caught on.

More accurately, her body's instincts reacted faster than her brain did in this regard.

Liang Shi's body felt somewhat hot.

The warm air blowing inside the car made one drowsy. Xu Qingzhu was wearing a white turtleneck base layer sweater, a very fitted style that showed off her graceful curves.

Now pressed close against her, one of her legs naturally hooked around Liang Shi's.

A tiny bit of sweat appeared on the tip of Liang Shi's nose.

"You being like this..." Liang Shi's voice trembled slightly, but she still couldn't finish her sentence.

She had wanted to say it was too love-brained¹ and not conducive to Xu Qingzhu's career development.

But her instincts told her that if she said that, Xu Qingzhu would get angry.

Perhaps because the atmosphere had reached this point, Liang Shi didn't want to ruin Xu Qingzhu's mood with such words either.

Xu Qingzhu pressed down on her glands.

The sensation was very pleasant. Liang Shi could barely hold back... yet she said softly: "Stop messing around."

But these words carried no deterrent power—to anyone's ears, they sounded no different from flirting.

"How am I messing around?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi looked at her, her gaze somewhat hazy. Xu Qingzhu's lips were very red, like sugar-coated hawthorns,² glistening brightly.

"Didn't you just tell me to stop messing around?" Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "Yes, but I never said I wouldn't mess around."

These words made absolutely no sense.

And they weren't even fair.

Yet Liang Shi was helpless against her.

And she quite enjoyed it.

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, her hand resting on her hair, indulging her: "Then how do you want to mess around?"

"You first." Xu Qingzhu said: "What were you just saying about me being like this?"

Even while questioning her, Xu Qingzhu wasn't being well-behaved—her hand gently caressed Liang Shi's neck.

The skin on Liang Shi's neck was very fair.

Xu Qingzhu bit it once. "Tell me."

The tip of Liang Shi's sweaty nose touched hers as she lifted her up from her embrace, her throat moving slightly.

Their eyes met. Liang Shi's hand fell to the back of her head, her fingers entangled in strands of her hair.

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, her light brown eyes full of indulgence.

Her voice was very low: "You being like that... I like it very much."

Xu Qingzhu smiled upon hearing this.

Liang Shi's hand applied slight pressure, and Xu Qingzhu leaned in, her body very soft.

When Xu Qingzhu kissed Liang Shi, she was quite intense.

Not intense in the conventional sense—she simply wanted to take in more.

From a psychological perspective, this seemed like very insecure behavior.

Craving to use these things to prove that the other person existed, that the other person loved her.

Liang Shi was too hot and cold.

Xu Qingzhu felt that Liang Shi treated her very well, but... it wasn't enough.

Xu Qingzhu wanted her to be even better.

All of Liang Shi's gentleness and consideration were based on the fact that—she was her wife.

If that identity were stripped away, Liang Shi didn't have much love for her.

In this relationship, she seemed to always be in a state where she could withdraw at any moment.

It had been this way from the very beginning.

Xu Qingzhu bit her tongue, then soothed her—but in reality, she was soothing her own emotions.

Xu Qingzhu knew that Liang Shi wasn't being good to her out of genuine feelings or because she liked her. From the very beginning, her kindness had come with ulterior motives. But she didn't mind.

In the past, when she hadn't gotten close, when she hadn't obtained it, that was one thing.

But now that she had gotten close, now that she had obtained it, she wanted more.

Xu Qingzhu felt herself becoming increasingly greedy.

But she wanted to hear Liang Shi praise her, wanted Liang Shi to look at her, wanted Liang Shi to... love her.

After the lingering, passionate kiss, Xu Qingzhu leaned close to Liang Shi's ear and whispered: "Jiejie~ I'm so greedy."

Footnotes:

¹ **Love-brained** (戀愛腦): A Chinese internet slang term describing someone who becomes completely consumed by romantic feelings, often to the detriment of other aspects of their life such as career, friendships, or rational decision-making. It implies being so head-over-heels in love that one loses perspective.

² **Sugar-coated hawthorns** (糖山楂): A traditional Chinese snack called "tanghulu" (糖葫蘆) or candied hawthorn berries. The hawthorn fruits are skewered on a stick and coated in hardened sugar syrup, giving them a bright red, glossy appearance. It's a popular street food, especially in northern China during winter.